Chapter 3

Developing Creative Assets

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An exciting dimension of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) is its potential use for the development of creative assets in marketing. Artists, graphic designers, marketing agency leaders, marketers of various levels, and even operational executives, increasingly use generative AI text-to-image and image-to-image asset creation to augment their presentations. These efforts enhance marketing campaigns and even create new designs and artwork from scratch.

Many creative leaders may argue (and understandably so) that the creative capabilities of GenAI today are no match for what human beings can do. That may be true for now, but the situation is unlikely to remain the case in the years ahead. In the last year alone, GenAI tools such as Adobe Firefly, Midjourney, and Stable Diffusion advanced immensely in their capabilities — for example, by achieving more realistic image generation and offering a more intuitive user interface. These advancements illustrate generative AI's potential as the technology gets more sophisticated.

But even more than the ever-advancing technological progress, the role of GenAI becomes more powerful when you pair it with human beings who can turbocharge creativity and drive productivity and efficiency. To explain this pairing further in this chapter, I begin by talking about

Where's Waldo? to demonstrate both the opportunities and the risks involved in using generative AI to augment your creative process.

Trying Out an AI-Generated Where's Waldo? Illustration

In early 2024, an illustrator who uses the handle @0xFramer on the social media platform X (formerly known as Twitter) created a series of *Where's Waldo?* images to showcase both the opportunities and the challenges that occur when you use GenAI to develop creative assets. This illustrator used the original look-and-find children's books by Martin Handford as inspiration and then used generative AI tools to create his own variations. For those of you who don't know the series, the book consists of detailed, double-page spread illustrations depicting dozens and dozens of people doing a variety of amusing activities in a given setting. Readers are challenged to find a character named Waldo somewhere in the group.

The illustrator (@0xFramer) showed how anyone can quickly use an AI tool to create similar *Where's Waldo?* illustrations. (Check out his creative process on YouTube at `www.youtube.com/watch?v=2nYxeZQmcj0`.) To do so, you need to provide your AI tools with a detailed description that encapsulates the essence of a *Where's Waldo?* scene. Follow these steps to define such an illustration by providing input to a tool such as DALL-E 3 (through `https://openai.com/dall-e-3`) or Midjourney (`www.midjourney.com/`):

1. **Describe the background that becomes the setting for your illustration.**
   You can specify a vibrant and detailed background, which can be a beach, a cityscape, an office, a medieval scene, a space station, and so on. The more intricate and crowded the scene, the better.
2. **Identify the characters that you need to appear in the illustration.**
   Mention the need for a large number of diverse characters engaged in various activities. They should be dressed in a wide range of costumes, performing numerous actions to create a lively, busy scene.
3. **Describe the Waldo-like character that should appear somewhere in the illustration.**
   Note that you want the character subtly placed within the scene, similar to Waldo in the Handford books. This character should be wearing a red-and-white striped shirt but blend in well with the surroundings.
4. **Detail the color and style of the illustration.**
   Indicate the colorfulness and whimsical style that mimics the original *Where's Waldo?* illustrations.

For the AI to successfully generate an image close to your vision, you need to make your description precise and detailed. See the prompt that I created by following the preceding steps to urge DALL-E to generate such an image:

> *A vibrant, densely populated beach scene filled with numerous characters engaging in various activities: playing volleyball, sunbathing, building sandcastles, swimming, and so on. The characters are dressed in colorful and diverse beach attire. Include a character resembling Waldo, wearing a red and white striped shirt, blue pants, and a beanie, subtly blended into the scene. The style should be whimsical and cartoonish, with bright colors.*

By using the preceding prompt as inspiration (and finding out about effective prompts in Book 2), try creating your own *Where's Waldo?* illustration either in DALL-E or Midjourney. Doing so can give you a sense of the possibilities when it comes to using generative AI to develop creative assets of all types.

Exploring an Approach for Creating Visual Assets with AI

To establish objectives and define an approach to developing creative assets by using artificial intelligence (AI) tools, you need to follow a structured process that ensures that your creations align with your product offering and marketing goals and resonate with your target audience. AI offers exciting possibilities for creative asset development, but it requires careful management across various dimensions — from aligning with brand values and ensuring ethical use to integrating with existing workflows and respecting legal boundaries. Balancing these factors is key to leveraging AI effectively and responsibly.



TIP You now have access to some emergent AI tools (such as `Jasper.ai` and `Thewordsmith.ai`) that enable you to input and store your brand style guide first — before you even begin creating assets. That way, any image that the AI tool creates for you conforms to the style set out in your brand style guide. Furthermore, you don't have to ask your AI tool of choice to create one image at a time. You can have it create several images in one go.

Follow these steps — and carefully document the prompts — to responsibly create and use AI-generated assets:

1. **Define the marketing objective that you're creating assets for.**
   For example, you may want to increase brand awareness for a new eco-friendly clothing line. You expect to accomplish this objective by using AI to create visually striking images that highlight the eco-friendly aspects of the clothing.
   Best marketing practice: Clearly define the purpose of the creative asset. Do you want to use it for brand awareness, product promotion, social media engagement, lead acquisition, or something else? Your objective can guide the style, composition, and elements of the creative asset.
2. **Understand the target audience that your marketing intends to reach.**
   The target audience for your eco-friendly clothing line may be environmentally conscious young adults ages 18 to 35 in suburban settings. The creative assets for the marketing project can consist of imagery that appeals to this demographic by prompting an AI tool to incorporate relevant themes and settings.
   Watch out: Ensure that the AI-generated content reflects your brand's voice and appeals to your target audience. For example, if an AI tool creates a series of edgy and humorous social media posts, but your brand is known for its serious and professional tone, this content may alienate your established customer base. Constantly align AI outputs with your brand guidelines and audience expectations.
3. **Decide on the marketing message or theme that you want your creative assets to support.**
   For example, the marketing team may decide that they want to anchor the message in the phrase *Sustainability meets style*. The task, in that case, would be to have the AI generate visuals that blend natural, replenishable elements (such as bamboo, organic cotton, or recycled materials) with fashionable clothing styles.
   Best marketing practice: Ensure that the images align with your brand's visual identity, including colors, typography, and overall style. Consistency helps in building brand recognition. Include details around the brand visual identity in the prompts that you write for the AI tool.
4. **Choose the right AI tools for the data that you have and the expected output.**
   You have a range of tools to choose from, so match the tool to your specific task. For example, DALL-E and Midjourney can create unique images from descriptions that you provide and can also use reference images (also known as *image prompting*) to set the style for the image you want created.
   Best marketing practice: You can combine AI image creation with other tools, such as photo-editing software, for further refinement. In fact, tools such as Adobe Photoshop now include GenAI capabilities that can help you create different skylines or extend a mountain in a different direction, for example.
   Watch out: The choice of AI tools and their training data significantly impacts the type and quality of creative output. For example, an AI model trained primarily on classical European art styles may not be suitable for a campaign aiming to reflect contemporary Asian aesthetics. Select tools and models that align with your specific creative goals. And you don't get a shortcut in this exercise:

The only way to know which tools are right for you involves experimenting with several.

5. **Develop detailed descriptions for your AI to work from.**
   An example description for the clothing line may be something like *stylish, modern outfit with bamboo fabric texture, set against a background of lush greenery, with a subtle hint of urban skyline.*
   Best marketing practice: When using AI tools such as DALL-E or Midjourney, the more specific your description, the better the results. Include details about colors, mood, setting, objects, and any text that you want in the image. Flip to the section "Trying Out an AI-Generated Where's Waldo? Illustration," earlier in this chapter, for inspiration.
6. **Insert a description that you create in Step 5 (with or without the assistance of an AI application) into your chosen text-to-image tool (such as DALL-E or Midjourney).**
   Ideally, generate at least four variations that you can then edit further (see Step 7).
7. **Make repeated modifications (iterations) to your descriptions, and then review and refine the assets that the tool creates.**
   Arguably, this step (or series of steps) is the most important. You must evaluate the AI-generated images and adjust the prompts to further enhance and strengthen the output. For example, if an initially created image lacks the vibrancy that you expect, adjust the description that you offer to the AI to include *bright, vivid colors.*
   Best marketing practice: AI-generated images may not be perfect on the first try. In fact, they're very rarely perfect on the first try. Fully expect to iterate constantly when you refine the prompts and tweak the creative asset.



REMEMBER AI is a tool to augment your creativity and efficiency. The combination of AI capabilities and your unique brand perspective can create the most powerful visual content. Arguably, AI is at its best when you combine it with human creativity versus asking it to do the creation on its own.

8. **Evaluate the created assets against brand standards to ensure quality and consistency.**
   Human involvement is critical, especially when evaluating whether the output reflects the desired quality and is on brand. Whether you match colors with the brand palette, check the output against other brand images, or use a separate AI tool that can check for brand consistency, you mustn't skip this step.
   Watch out: Don't think of AI as a set-and-forget tool. Regular human oversight ensures the quality of AI-generated content. For example, an AI tool may inadvertently use outdated or inappropriate cultural references in marketing materials. Regular reviews by human editors can catch and correct these missteps. In fact, your marketing department and team should have a policy for verifying every new creative asset generated by the AI before that asset goes out into the world.
9. **Optimize the generated assets for various platforms that you intend to use for marketing.**

After you finalize an image, you can use AI tools (such as Canva or Adobe Spark) to help optimize the output for various platforms. For example, AI tools can create square images for Instagram and wider formats for Facebook banners.

Best marketing practice: Different social media platforms have different preferred image sizes and aspect ratios. Customize your images accordingly for optimal display. When you're using an AI tool to create images or even video, you can input the desired output sizes that you need.

Watch out: Smoothly integrate AI tools into existing workflows. For instance, an AI video editing tool that doesn't integrate well with your current video editing software can create more work, instead of streamlining the process. Ensure that any AI tool you adopt fits seamlessly into your existing production pipeline and also has the appropriate import and export capability.

10. **Test the created visual asset's effect on the intended audience and gather feedback.**

    Testing the creative output (whether that's a static image or video) by using a focus group or even a small internal audience, who can help you see whether it resonates positively. Use that feedback to guide the AI tool on further image refinements, as needed.

    Best marketing practice: AI offers the flexibility to explore various artistic styles and formats. Experiment with different aesthetics to see what resonates best with your audience.

    Watch out: Biases can slip into AI-generated content. If an AI tool consistently generates images of people in stereotypical roles based on gender or race, this output could reflect and perpetuate harmful biases.



REMEMBER Embed legal and ethical compliance in all steps of the process for creating assets with AI tools. In particular

- When choosing the right AI tool and assessing the output, ensure that the images don't infringe on copyrights and are ethically sound. Check whether the AI tool indemnifies you from potential copyright claims and find out whether your legal team is onboard with the tools and the process that you're using. Check out Book 1, Chapter 6, for more discussion of legal and ethical compliance.
- Stay informed about legal aspects of AI, especially in terms of copyright and intellectual property rights. For example, using AI to generate music for a commercial project may raise copyright issues if the AI's training data includes copyrighted music. Ensure that your use of AI respects legal boundaries and intellectual property rights. And, although tools such as Adobe Firefly, Microsoft Copilot, and OpenAI's DALL-E offer IP indemnification, still check with your legal team.

Minding the integrity of your customers, data, and teams

Maintain ethical integrity and transparency when you use AI to create customer-facing content. For example, if you use AI to create realistic hu-

man images or voices, disclose that these images are AI-generated to avoid misleading your audience about the reality of what they're seeing. With industry efforts to label AI-generated content gathering steam, make sure that you maintain alignments with new developments.



REMEMBER If your AI tools use customer data to personalize content, ensure strict adherence to data privacy laws. For example, using AI to personalize e-mail campaigns requires careful handling of customer data in compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) or other relevant privacy regulations. Failure to do so can lead to legal consequences and damage to your brand's reputation. And make sure to involve your legal team in your conversations regarding customer data use.

Invest in training your team to use AI tools effectively. Lack of understanding can lead to your team underutilizing AI capabilities. For example, a content team not fully trained in using an AI copywriting tool may only use it for basic tasks (such as grammar checking) and miss out on its advanced features for generating more sophisticated content (for example, creating personalized marketing copy). Keep in mind that when your team chooses to use an AI tool, it probably means more work, not less, in the short term while they familiarize themselves with the tool's capabilities and integrate the tool into their regular workflow.



REMEMBER Make sure that your efforts don't rely too heavily on AI; doing so can hinder creativity and innovation. For example, if a graphic design team uses AI exclusively for creating visuals, they may miss out on unique, human-inspired designs. Balance AI use with human creativity to foster innovation. You don't want your brand to flood its marketing channels with bland, plain, and boring content.



TIP When you're creating images or video by using AI, some of the AI tools available for use come from the companies whose tools you've used for a long time. These tools now include powerful AI functionality to enhance your creative work. Adobe Photoshop is a perfect example of a design tool that now includes some interesting generative AI functionality that you can use with just a little bit of extra training.

Examining an example scenario

Suppose that you're working on a campaign for the eco-friendly clothing line that I introduce in the section "Exploring an Approach for Creating Visual Assets with AI," earlier in this chapter. After defining your objective and understanding your target audience, you may decide that the theme for your marketing campaign is *Urban Nature.* Then, you select Midjourney as your AI tool to create initial designs that will appeal to young adults. You make your descriptions to Midjourney detailed and focus on elements that signify both suburban life and nature. For example, you may describe a bamboo-fabric jacket set against a city park backdrop.

After several iterations to ensure that the images align with your brand's visual identity, you tailor these images for various social media platforms where you plan to present your marketing campaign. Before finalizing, you gather feedback from a focus group or, at the very least, other team members to test that the images resonate well with your target demographic. Lastly, you double-check all legal and ethical aspects of using AI-generated images in your campaign.

Enhancing Existing Creative Assets

Using AI to enhance or edit existing creative assets involves several innovative techniques that have revolutionized the approach to creativity and asset development. AI's role in enhancing and editing creative assets spans a wide array of applications, from restoring and enhancing old media to creating entirely new content.

Current marketers more frequently use AI for editing and enhancing existing images than they do for creating images from scratch. However, I expect that situation to change in the future. Advancements in AI's capabilities don't only save time and reduce manual effort; they represent a paradigm shift in how marketers approach creative work as a blend of human imagination and machine efficiency.

The following sections describe four distinct ways in which you can use AI for modifying your existing creative visuals.

Enhancing and restoring images

AI-infused tools can significantly improve the quality of existing images. Tools such as Photoshop now integrate AI for tasks including upscaling resolution, enhancing details, and restoring old photographs. For exam-

ple, AI algorithms can analyze a low-resolution image and intelligently fill in details that the original image didn't actually contain, resulting in a high-resolution version. In photo restoration, AI can remove scratches, adjust faded colors, and even reconstruct missing parts of an image. This capability is particularly valuable in preserving historical photographs or rejuvenating old family pictures.

One of my favorite features in Adobe Photoshop is the Sky Replacement functionality, which allows you to change the sky featured in an existing image based on the criteria that you set. The technology behind these tools, not surprisingly, involves neural networks trained on vast data sets of images, enabling the AI to predict and replicate realistic textures and details.

Enhancing and clarifying audio

Similar to its capabilities for image restoration (see the preceding section), AI's audio processing features make it adept at creating, enhancing, and restoring audio recordings. This functionality is especially useful for remastering old music tracks, restoring archival audio recordings, or improving the clarity of voice recordings.

AI algorithms can isolate different audio elements, remove background noise, and even separate voice sounds from music. For instance, AI can take an old mono track and *upmix* it (extract separate tracks) to stereo or surround sound, breathing new life into classic songs. Tools such as Izotope's RX series use machine learning to identify and repair common audio issues — such as clicks, pops, or hisses — that often occur in older recordings. The BMW example that I talk about in the sidebar "Case Study: BMW's AI-Generated Soundtrack," in this chapter, touches on the potential of using AI to create or enhance audio.

Analyzing and editing video

AI is automating time-consuming video-editing tasks such as object removal, color grading, and even *frame interpolation* (creating and inserting new video frames between existing ones), which results in smoother transitions for slow-motion effects. AI tools can automate the process of analyzing and editing videos frame by frame, which can significantly reduce the manual labor involved in video post-production. For example, AI can automatically identify and tag various elements in a video — such as faces, objects, or landscapes — and enable quick editing or effects application.

Adobe's Sensei AI and Blackmagic Design's DaVinci Resolve with its *neural engine* are examples of AI technologies that empower editors to achieve more in less time, enhancing the overall quality and visual appeal of videos. Simpler AI tools, such as Animoto or Lumen5, also allow you to enter natural language queries into the application and provide guidelines for creating short instructional videos.

Adding and modifying content

You can use AI to modify or create elements within existing assets. For instance, AI-driven tools such as DALL-E or GPT-4 can generate new visual or textual content that matches the style or theme of existing assets. You can use this functionality to create variations of an ad campaign, generate additional scenes in a video game, or even produce explanatory images for a book.



REMEMBER The AI models that you use for supplementing assets are trained on vast data sets and can generate highly original and contextually appropriate content. This capability not only speeds up the creative process, but also opens up new avenues for creativity that were previously unimaginable.

CASE STUDY: COCA-COLA'S "MASTERPIECE" CAMPAIGN

In an era when keeping a heritage brand vibrant and relevant is a formidable challenge, Coca-Cola embarked on a journey in 2023 to infuse its timeless appeal with the cutting-edge allure of AI. The objective was clear: To intertwine Coca-Cola's enduring promise of uplifting refreshment with the dynamism of AI, thereby sparking creativity and connection in the fabric of daily life. The campaign hoped to captivate a global audience with its memorable narrative.

To achieve this, Coca-Cola harnessed the power of generative AI, collaborating with OpenAI, Electric Theatre Collective, and Blitzworks to craft an innovative short film titled "Masterpiece." The film presents an eclectic mix of classical and contemporary art from around the globe, all in a museum setting. It weaves a tale in which a Coca-Cola bottle journeys through various paintings, ultimately inspiring an art student. This journey is brought to life through a blend of live-action, digital artistry, and AI-driven animation, showcasing the bottle's transformation as it traverses different artistic realms. Notably, the film incorporates Stable

Diffusion, OpenAI's DALL-E 2, and GPT-4.0 to generate unique paintings and dialogues, showcasing the seamless integration of AI in creative storytelling.

Not only was the film a shining example of how to use generative AI in asset creation, but its exposure also lifted Coca-Cola's brand metrics, including a 12 percent increase in brand recall, a 9 percent improvement in brand favorability, and a 7 percent rise in purchase intent for the target audience, as highlighted in a survey from the research firm Kantar. The campaign also achieved viral success, amassing millions of views, likes, and comments across social media platforms and garnering acclaim with accolades such as the Cannes LIONS Grand Prix for Film Craft, among others.

For marketers, this initiative illustrates the boundless possibilities of blending traditional art and creative asset development with AI, offering fresh perspectives on brand storytelling. By leveraging generative AI, Coca-Cola demonstrated how different tools can lead to entirely new creative concepts that stay on brand and produce strong advertising results.

Fine-Tuning Creativity with AI Tools and Techniques

To fine-tune the creation of visual marketing assets by using AI tools, you have to hone your skills in working with those tools. For example, you can improve the effectiveness of the written descriptions that you use as input for the AI created content. You can also streamline your asset production process and employ various tricks to make sure that the assets created grab your customers' attention. The following sections can help you get started in becoming an AI–content creation wiz.

Crafting descriptions for image creation

To get high-quality AI images, you need to craft detailed descriptions. Here are five examples of descriptions provided to an AI tool — each tailored for a different scenario — to give you inspiration for creating your own imagery or video:

- **Product promotion in lifestyle setting:**
  A cozy, modern living room at dusk, with soft ambient lighting. In the center, a sleek, black, smart coffee maker sits on a rustic wooden table. The background shows a comfortable sofa with colorful cushions and a bookshelf filled with

books. There's a large window with sheer curtains, showcasing a city skyline at twilight.

- **Fashion advertisement for a youth brand:**
  A vibrant street art backdrop with graffiti, showcasing a diverse group of young adults wearing trendy streetwear. The clothing includes graphic T-shirts, ripped jeans, and colorful sneakers. Each person is striking a dynamic pose, exuding confidence and style. The setting is an urban alleyway, bustling with energy, and the lighting is bright and lively, emphasizing the vivid colors of the clothes and graffiti.
- **Travel promotion for a tropical destination:**
  A breathtaking beach scene at sunset, with a clear view of the ocean meeting the horizon. The sky is a blend of orange, pink, and purple hues. Palm trees gently sway in the foreground, framing a hammock tied between two trees. In the background, there's a glimpse of a luxury over-water bungalow with a thatched roof. The water is crystal clear, and there's a sense of serene beauty and tranquility. Nobody is around.
- **Gourmet food advertisement:**
  An elegant dining table set outdoors in a lush garden during the day. The table showcases a gourmet spread: a cheese board with an assortment of cheeses, grapes, and nuts; a freshly baked artisanal bread; and a bottle of red wine with two glasses. The background features blooming flowers and greenery, with soft, natural sunlight filtering through the leaves, creating a warm and inviting atmosphere.
- **Tech product launch:**
  A futuristic, minimalist office space with a large, sleek, curved desk. On the desk, there's a cutting-edge silver laptop with a glowing logo. The room has a large glass window revealing a cityscape with high-tech skyscrapers. The lighting is cool and blue, giving a high-tech, innovative vibe. In the foreground, holographic projections display graphs and code, symbolizing advanced technology and innovation.

Automating creative production

Automating the creative production process by using AI involves integrating intelligent tools at various stages of the workflow. This approach can significantly enhance efficiency, spark creativity, and ensure consistency across projects. The following list gives you a detailed explanation of how to use AI tools in the creative production process, with specific examples and recommendations:

- **Concept and planning:** The first step in any creative asset production is conceptualization and planning. AI tools such as OpenAI's GPT-4 can assist in generating creative concepts and ideas. For example, you can prompt GPT-4 to generate unique storylines, advertising copy, or design concepts based on initial input criteria. This assistance can help you in brainstorming sessions to provide a broad range of ideas and angles that may not be immediately obvious to human marketing teams.



REMEMBER AI-powered project management tools can assist in planning the production timeline, resource allocation, and budgeting by analyzing data from previous projects to predict timelines and potential bottlenecks.

- **Design and asset creation:** In the design phase, AI tools such as Adobe Sensei and Autodesk's AI solutions can greatly expedite the process. These tools can automate repetitive tasks such as image resizing, color correction, and basic layout design. For instance, Adobe Sensei can intelligently crop photos, keeping the main subjects in frame, or suggest design layouts in Adobe Spark. Autodesk's AI, on the other hand, can assist in 3D design processes by suggesting optimizations of model structures and automating certain modeling tasks, such as generating textures or refining mesh details.

  You can also use AI tools to generate initial design templates or even come up with complete assets. Tools such as DALL-E, Midjourney, or Runway enable users to create visuals and design elements from textual descriptions, which offers a fast and unique way to create custom graphics.
- **Content development and writing:** For content creation, AI writing assistants such as Jasper, Writer, or TheWordsmith.ai can generate drafts for articles, scripts, or social media posts. These tools use advanced natural language processing (NLP) to create coherent and contextually relevant content based on keywords or short descriptions. Although AI-generated text often requires human editing to add a personal touch or specific brand voice, these tools can save considerable time in the initial drafting phase.



TIP Find out about the type of writing tools (such as Jasper.ai, Writer.ai, Copy.ai, and TheWordsmith.ai) that can incorporate your brand style guidelines before generating any content. Also, keep your audience in mind: AI can assist in *language translation* and *localization of content* (see Chapter 6 in this book for more about these topics), ensuring that the creative output is accessible to a global audience.

- **Editing in video post-production:** During the post-production process for a video asset, AI can significantly streamline the editing process. Tools such as Adobe Premiere Pro's Auto Reframe use AI to automatically adjust the aspect ratio of videos for different platforms. For example, the tools can transition from a widescreen format to a square format for social media.

  For audio production, tools such as Descript offer AI-driven transcription and editing, which enables the creators to edit audio files by adjusting the transcribed text. This type of process can dramatically reduce editing time. In photography and image editing, AI tools can automate tasks such as object removal, sky replacement, or style transfer, as offered in Skylum's Luminar.
- **Review and optimization:** AI-powered analytics tools can analyze audience engagement with creative content and provide insights into what content works and what doesn't. For instance, tools such as Canva's Magic Switch or Google Analytics can offer data-driven recommendations for design adjustments or content tweaks to help you maximize engagement and reach.



TIP Increasingly, tools such as VidMob use AI to analyze all the advertising that you create *longitudinally* (repeatedly over long periods of time) to determine which types of content and what elements in that content produce the best results. The tool then uses those insights to fuel recommendations for adjustments to new content that you create.



REMEMBER When integrating AI into creative production, maintain a balance between automation and human creativity. AI is best used as a tool to augment and assist the creative process, rather than replace it. Have your creators familiarize themselves with a range of AI tools so that they can understand which tools best suit their specific needs. Also, make sure that everyone continuously updates their skills and knowledge about new AI tools and advancements because the field is rapidly evolving.

Tips and tricks for producing attention-grabbing creative assets

Producing attention-grabbing creative assets by using AI requires a multifaceted process that capitalizes on the unique capabilities of AI tools to create content that's not only visually appealing or engaging but also resonates with your target audience. Effective utilization of AI can transform the way you conceptualize, develop, and deliver content:

- **Customized content:** AI tools such as Adobe Target can personalize content based on user data and preferences. You can see this approach in AI-driven campaigns for online retailers, where images of products are dynamically generated to align with the interests of specific users. Similarly, Google's responsive display ads use AI to test various combinations of headlines, descriptions, and images, optimizing ad performance for different target audiences. This dynamic content adaptation ensures that each user receives the most relevant and engaging experience. Dynamic Yield, Oracle Maxymiser, and Vue.ai are a few of the other tools that provide this content customization.
- **Design and video:** Specialized tools, such as Stable Diffusion and Runway, enable the creation of unique AI-generated visuals. For instance, a marketing campaign incorporating AI-generated artwork that merges brand elements with distinct artistic styles results in a visually unique and memorable experience. Additionally, AI-powered image enhancement tools, such as Let's Enhance or Adobe Photoshop's AI features, can significantly improve image quality, making your content sharper and more attention-grabbing.



TIP Visit the Runway website (`http://runwayml.com`) and check out their suite of tools to see the potential. Their AI tool suite includes tools for text to video, image to image, erase and replace, backdrop remix, remove silence, add color, and green screen creation capabilities.

- **Video and animation:** Automated video editing tools, such as Lumen5 and Magisto, can convert blog posts or textual content into engaging video content by selecting relevant stock images or video clips, overlaying text, and adding music. Additionally, AI animation tools, such as Synthesia, allow for the creation of custom avatars that can deliver messages in a more personalized and engaging manner, such as creating an AI spokesperson for a brand. Some of these tools aren't free, but they're not expensive either. As I write this book, Lumen5 starts at $19 a month for unlimited usage.
- **Creative copywriting:** In the domain of copywriting, AI tools such as Jasper, Writer, or Copy.ai can produce a range of styles and tones, tailored to different platforms, brands, and audiences, which enhances the engagement level of ads, social media posts, or product descriptions. Moreover, AI tools such as CoSchedule's Headline Analyzer can help you craft attention-grabbing headlines, using algorithms to analyze and predict the engagement level of various word choices.
- **Audio production:** Tools such as AIVA or Amper Music enable the creation of custom music tracks, allowing users to select a mood or style for the AI to generate a unique piece of music. Furthermore, AI voice synthesis tools, such as Descript, offer realistic voiceovers for videos or podcasts, streamlining the production process and providing greater flexibility in content creation.

CASE STUDY: BMW'S AI-GENERATED SOUNDTRACK

BMW, a leading global automotive brand renowned for its commitment to technological innovation, sought a distinctive approach that would resonate with a younger, tech-savvy demographic. The brand identified an opportunity to leverage its association with cutting-edge technology by collaborating with Tomorrowland, the annual electronic music dance festival, to create a unique brand experience that underscores its innovative ethos.

BMW launched Future Record, an AI-driven music platform developed in partnership with Tomorrowland. This platform offered users an interactive experience in which they can craft their own AI-generated tracks. By engaging with Future Record, participants were prompted to answer a series of questions regarding their preferences, such as stage name, tempo, mood, and lyrics. The platform then used those inputs to generate a bespoke song that captured the essence of the user's asks. This process, re-

markably efficient, produces personalized songs in under a minute, which users were able to share on social platforms.

The Future Record initiative generated more than 10,000 unique tracks and garnered more than 20 million impressions on social media. This campaign significantly boosted BMW's brand awareness and fostered deeper engagement and loyalty among BMW and Tomorrowland's audiences.

Future Record served dual purposes: to showcase the potential of using generative AI to create new music and to strengthen BMW's technology credentials. It showed how generative AI can be used not just by one but by thousands of consumers to create new music that, in turn, reinforced the BMW brand. Furthermore, it hints at the possibilities when you use generative AI to create custom soundtracks for your consumers on a huge scale — forging a stronger and more nuanced connection with them.

Choosing AI Tools for Creating Visual Assets

Using AI to develop or enhance creative assets has become increasingly popular, especially in marketing. Each tool has its unique strengths, and the best choice depends on your specific needs. For example, your priority may be the style of images that you want to create, how easily you can pick up and use the tool that you choose, or whether you can integrate the tool with your existing workflow. Always consider the tool's compatibility with your marketing objectives and brand identity.



TIP Stay informed about the latest developments in AI tools by reading industry newsletters, following relevant tech blogs, and participating in professional forums because the technology is rapidly evolving. Specifically, find out about AI image creation tools to leverage new features and capabilities. For example, Apple just launched an AI image tool that lets you make edits by using *natural language querying* (conversational English instructions).

Table 3-1 shows some of the best tools currently available for AI-generated imagery.

TABLE 3-1 AI-Generated Visual Asset Tools

Tool	*Website*	*Description*	*Bene*
Adobe Photoshop's Neural Filters	www.adobe.com/products/photoshop/neural-filter.html	An add-on to Adobe Creative Suite that allows you to manipulate and transform images	Easy incor rate f those ready ing Adob Creat Suite
Artbreeder	www.artbreeder.com	Blend and mutate images to create new visuals, explore variations in design elements, and create unique images	Explo varia tions desig elem
Canva's Magic Write	www.canva.com/magic-write	Generate design layouts and elements based on textual descriptions	Simp the d sign proce for mar keter
DALL-E 3 by OpenAI	http://openai.com/dall-e-3	Generate highly creative and detailed images from textual descriptions	Gene high quali imag and cus tomiz tions

Tool	*Website*	*Description*	*Bene*
Deep Dream Generator	http://deepdreamgenerator.com	Create surreal and abstract image transformations and eye-catching, dream-like images	Enab artist imag enha ment
Lumen5	http://lumen5.com	Video-creation tool that uses AI to help turn text content into engaging video material	Ease use, a cessil ty, an time savin
Midjourney	www.midjourney.com	Generates images from natural language descriptions	Most ly acc ble vi Disco the o line c muni platf
NightCafe Studio	http://creator.nightcafe.studio	Offers various AI art-generation techniques, including neural style transfer and text-to-image generation	User-frien and versa
Runway	http://runwayml.com	A user-friendly	Allow exper

Tool	*Website*	*Description*	*Bene*
		platform for creating AI-generated images and videos	ment tion v differ AI m with deep techn know edge
Stability AI's Stable Diffusion	`http://stability.ai/stable-image`	AI-powered open source large language model (LLM) that generates digital images based on textual descriptions	Good high- quali imag gene tion v lots o detai
VanceAI	`http://vanceai.com`	AI-powered image editing tools, including image upscaling, denoising, and restoration	Usefu impr ing th quali existi imag graph